



The Transcript Proofing Checklist

Eight quick passes every certified court reporter can run before turning in a transcript — the same categories of errors Court Reportcard checks for automatically.

A transcript rarely fails because of one big mistake — it fails, gets flagged, or quietly erodes a reporter's reputation because of small ones that slip past a tired final read. Run through this before you certify, or use it to train a new reporter on what "proofread" actually means.

1 Names & Proper Nouns

- ☐ **Every name spelled consistently** across the caption, appearances page, and body.
- ☐ **Spellings confirmed on the record** where a witness or attorney spelled a name aloud.
- ☐ **Company, product, and place names** verified, especially ones that sound like ordinary words.

2 Speaker ID & Colloquy

- ☐ **Speaker tags match** who is actually speaking during fast cross-talk.
- ☐ **Q&A attribution is correct** after objections, sidebars, or a change of examining attorney.
- ☐ **Overlapping speech** is broken into separate lines per speaker, not merged.

3 Punctuation That Changes Meaning

- ☐ **Commas around restrictive clauses** — a misplaced comma can change the claim entirely.
- ☐ **Question marks vs. periods** on lines that read either way, especially in rapid cross.
- ☐ **Em dashes for self-interruption** used consistently, not swapped with ellipses.

4 Numbers, Dates & Figures

- ☐ **Dollar amounts and quantities** double-checked — a transposed digit in damages is serious.
- ☐ **Dates consistent** with day of week and other dates referenced earlier.
- ☐ **Exhibit and page numbers** match the numbering used elsewhere in the case file.

5 Homophones & Sound-Alikes

- ☐ **Classic pairs:** there/their, to/too/two, your/you're, principal/principle, affect/effect.
- ☐ **Legal sound-alikes:** cite/site/sight, council/counsel, deposition/disposition.
- ☐ **Technical/industry terms** spelled correctly even when they sound like ordinary words.

6 Formatting & Certification

- ☐ **Certificate page** present, signed, and matching your state's required language.
- ☐ **Appearances page** complete — every attorney, party, and role accounted for.
- ☐ **Line numbering, margins, font** consistent with your jurisdiction's rules.

7 Recess & Procedural Notations

- ☐ **Every recess/off-the-record break** is noted with a timestamp where required.
- ☐ **Resumption of proceedings** is clearly marked, including changes in who's present.
- ☐ **Objections and rulings** notated in the format your court or firm expects.

8 Final Read-Through Pass

- ☐ **Read once for sense** — does each answer logically follow the question asked?
- ☐ **Flag anything that made you pause** on first read; it's usually worth resolving.
- ☐ **Step away and re-read** after a break — fatigue causes most missed errors.

Let Court Reportcard run this checklist for you. Upload a transcript and get an automated pass across these exact categories in minutes, before you certify. Try it free: www.courtreportcard.com